

Michael B. Murillo

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Kindergarten & Primary Homeroom Teacher | Early Literacy & Phonics | EAL/ESL | Inquiry-Based / PYP-Informed Instruction

PROFESSIONAL SUMMARY

Kindergarten and primary educator with 10+ years of experience across China and Southeast Asia, currently serving as a Kindergarten Homeroom Teacher in Chengdu. Known for strong relationships with students, steady classroom management, and well-prepared early literacy instruction, including phonics, CVC blending, and decodable reading routines. Experienced in inclusive differentiation, social-emotional learning, family communication, and inquiry-based teaching using PYP elements.

Moreland University - Teach-Now Teacher Preparation Program (Washington, DC licensure track)

Completed April 2026 | State-approved teacher preparation program leading to U.S. teacher certification | U.S. teacher certification exams pending

CORE STRENGTHS

Homeroom teaching (K–Primary) • Early literacy & phonics • SEL & classroom culture
Inclusive differentiation (ADHD and autism) • EAL/ESL support • Family communication • Inquiry-based teaching
Progress monitoring & informal assessment • PE, movement-based learning, and coaching • Child safeguarding & student well-being

CERTIFICATION & EDUCATION

Moreland University — Teach-Now Teacher Preparation Program
Washington, DC licensure track | Program completed: Apr 2026 | U.S. teacher certification exams pending

- B.A. in Psychology, Cornell College (USA), 1999–2003
- Graduate coursework: Child Development & Coaching, Wright Graduate University (USA), 2010–2013
- TEFL Certificate, EF Education First (China), 2014
- Cambridge English TKT Certification, 2014

TEACHING EXPERIENCE

American Eagle Institute / Yiguo Kindergarten (弋果) | Chengdu, China

Kindergarten Homeroom Teacher | Sept 2025 – Present

- Serve as full-time homeroom teacher for rotating Pre-K and K1 cohorts, delivering daily instruction across early literacy, math foundations, thematic learning, and social-emotional development while maintaining consistent routines, behavior expectations, and learning continuity across monthly transitions.
- Built a structured phonics routine centered on sound review, arm-tapping blending, CVC reading, games, and targeted follow-up practice to strengthen letter-sound connection, blending, and early reading confidence.
- Differentiate instruction through visuals, reduced distraction supports, calm down strategies, and one to one check ins for mixed-ability learners, including students with ADHD and autism.
- Teach SEL through a traffic light routine (green, yellow, red) and breathing resets, helping students build emotional awareness, self-regulation, and calmer classroom behavior.
- Lead PE and movement-based activities that support physical coordination, self-regulation, listening, and class engagement.
- Monitor progress through observation notes, workbook checks, decoding and blending checks, and one-to-one support, then adjust pacing and instruction to student needs.
- Maintain strong parent relationships through weekly communication and a caring, patient, professional classroom presence praised by families.
- Trusted to support family and community facing events, including the January 2026 Culture Exchange, Oceans Around the World.

Golden Apple Kindergarten | Chengdu, China

ESL Teacher | Sept 2024 – Jul 2025

- Taught English to children ages 2–6 using songs, stories, games, and hands-on activities to build vocabulary, comprehension, and confidence.

- Differentiated instruction by developmental stage and learning profile, adjusting pacing, language supports, and classroom routines.
- Contributed to instructional improvements during a year of significant school progress, as campus evaluation performance rose from the bottom tier toward the middle range among approximately 40 schools.

Kunming Concord College of Sino-Canada | Kunming, China

IB PYP Teacher & ESL Teacher | Sept 2023 – Jul 2024

- Designed and taught inquiry-based units using PYP elements, including ATL skills, learner profile connections, reflection, concept-based questioning, and formative assessment to support language growth and participation.
- Developed a tailored ESL program using structured routines and targeted scaffolds to strengthen conversational and classroom language.
- Taught units in Grade 1 emotional intelligence and Grade 2 sustainability, linking academic language to real-world themes and student curiosity.

EF English First Kids & Teens | Shenzhen, China

Senior Teacher | Nov 2017 – Sept 2023

- Delivered ESL instruction to learners ages 3–18 and supported teacher onboarding through mentoring, model lessons, and practical classroom feedback.
- Contributed to school community life through family-facing events, cultural programming, and education-focused social media content.

EF Eduka Group | Surabaya, Indonesia

Director of Studies / Senior Teacher | Feb 2016 – Aug 2017

- Led curriculum planning and teacher development while helping oversee cultural activities and off-site events with attention to safety, logistics, and student experience.

EF English First Kids & Teens | Shenzhen, China

ESL Teacher | Jul 2014 – Aug 2016

- Taught English to students ages 3–18 using interactive routines and differentiated instruction; contributed to curriculum development and new-teacher support.

ADDITIONAL EXPERIENCE

Variety, the Children's Charity of Illinois | Chicago, USA

Event Coordinator | 2011 – 2014

- Planned and executed fundraising events benefiting children with mobility disabilities, coordinating volunteers, vendors, and event logistics.

Wright Business, Inc. | Chicago, USA

Life Principles Teacher & Coach | 2012 – 2014

- Designed and facilitated adult workshops and coaching sessions focused on personal development, job-search resilience, and moving beyond the drama triangle.

PROFESSIONAL DEVELOPMENT

- Social Media Content Creation for Educators, EF English First (2022)
- Event Planning & Risk Assessment, EF English First (2021)
- Life Principles Teacher & Coach Training, Wright Living (2008–2015)

LANGUAGES & TECHNOLOGY

Languages: Native English | Mandarin: basic conversational/instructional | Spanish: basic conversational/instructional
 Technology: Microsoft 365 / Microsoft Office (Word, PowerPoint, Excel) | Seewo interactive whiteboard instruction | PowerPoint-based lesson design | Canva-based lesson design